African Continental Free Trade Area

Status of negotiations and ratification

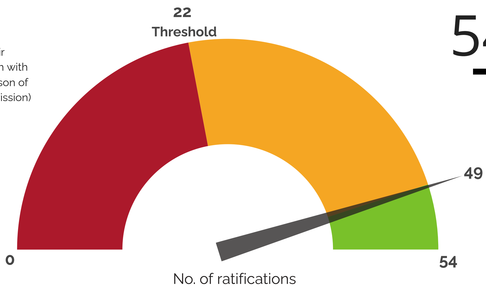
AfCFTA Ratification Barometer

According to Article 23 of the AfCFTA Agreement, entry into force occurs 30 days after the 22nd instrument of ratification is deposited with the Chairperson of the African Union Commission (AUC) – the designated depositary for this purpose. The Agreement entered into force on 30 May 2019 for the 24 countries that had deposited their instruments of ratification by this date.

49 No. of countries

that have deposited their instruments of ratification with the depositary (Chairperson of the African Union Commission)

50 countries have complied with their domestic requirements for ratification of the AfCFTA Agreement (deposit of Sudan's ratification outstanding)



54 No. of signatories

(countries) that have signed the consolidated text of the Agreement Establishing the AfCFTA

1 country of the 55 AU member states has yet to sign the AfCFTA Agreement (Eritrea)

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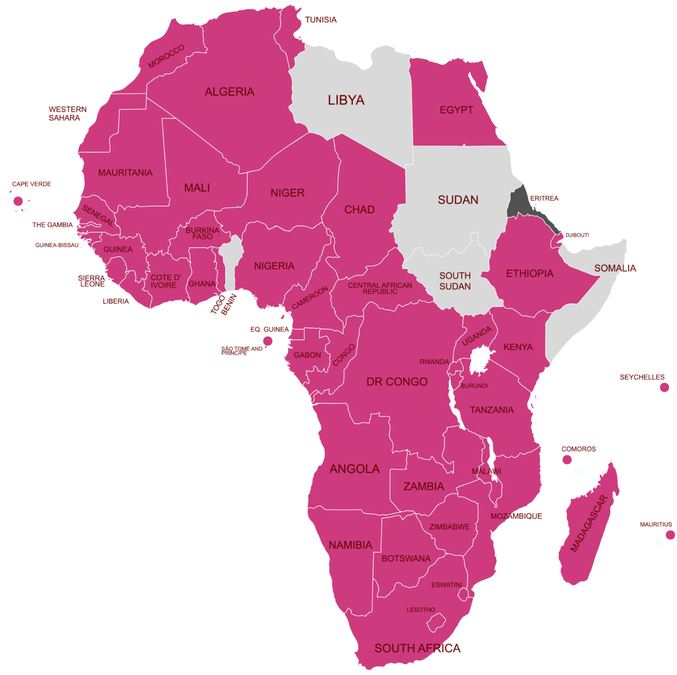
Which countries have ratified the AfCFTA Agreement?



- Instrument of ratification deposited
- AfCFTA Agreement signed
- AfCFTA Agreement not signed

Last updated: December 2025

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Listed by date on which the AfCFTA instrument of ratification was deposited with the AUC Chairperson

Ghana	10-05-2018
Kenya	10-05-2018
Rwanda	26-05-2018
Niger	19-06-2018
Chad	02-07-2018
Eswatini	02-07-2018
Guinea	16-10-2018
Côte d'Ivoire	23-11-2018
Mali	01-02-2019
Namibia	01-02-2019
Uganda	09-02-2019
South Africa	10-02-2019
Congo, Rep.	10-02-2019
Djibouti	11-02-2019
Mauritania	11-02-2019
Senegal	02-04-2019
Togo	02-04-2019
Egypt	08-04-2019
Ethiopia	10-04-2019
Gambia	16-04-2019
Sahrawi Arab Democratic Rep.	30-04-2019
Sierra Leone	30-04-2019
Zimbabwe	24-05-2019
Burkina Faso	29-05-2019
São Tomé & Principe	27-06-2019
Equatorial Guinea	02-07-2019
Gabon	07-07-2019
Mauritius	07-10-2019
Central African Rep.	22-09-2020
Angola	04-11-2020
Lesotho	27-11-2020
Tunisia	27-11-2020
Cameroon	01-12-2020
Nigeria	05-12-2020
Malawi	15-01-2021
Zambia	05-02-2021
Algeria	23-06-2021
Burundi	26-08-2021
Seychelles	15-09-2021
Tanzania	17-01-2022
Cape Verde	05-02-2022
Democratic Rep. of the Congo	23-02-2022
Morocco	20-04-2022
Guinea-Bissau	27-09-2022
Botswana	19-02-2023
Comoros	19-02-2023
Mozambique	05-07-2023
Liberia	31-07-2024
Madagascar	Date TBC

Negotiations: Current status

January 2026

Preferential trade can only truly begin once negotiations on outstanding issues on Trade in Goods, such as tariff concessions and rules of origin, are concluded. Progress on rules of origin for trade in clothing and textiles and automatives was made at the 17th Council of Ministers Meeting held in Cairo, Egypt in September 2025. The process is expected to be finalised in 2026.
State Parties that have *gazetted* their Provisional Schedules of Tariff Concessions can trade under AfCFTA rules.

Phase I

Trade in Goods

48
State Parties have submitted Provisional Schedules of Tariff Concessions for Category A goods

92.4%
of tariff lines have been agreed (textiles and apparrel, and automotives due to be completed in 2026)

8 561
Certificates of Origin submitted by end-June 2025

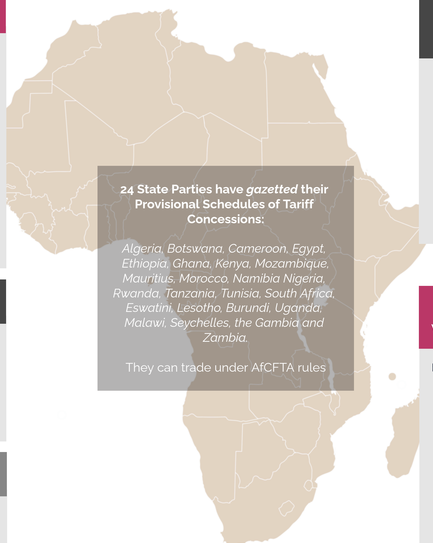
Trade in Services

50
State Parties have submitted initial services offers in the 5 priority sectors

25
adopted Schedules of Commitments

Dispute Settlement

Protocol on Rules and Procedures on the Settlement of Disputes and its 3 Annexes in force.



24 State Parties have *gazetted* their Provisional Schedules of Tariff Concessions:

Algeria, Botswana, Cameroon, Egypt, Ethiopia, Ghana, Kenya, Mozambique, Mauritius, Morocco, Namibia Nigeria, Rwanda, Tanzania, Tunisia, South Africa, Eswatini, Lesotho, Burundi, Uganda, Malawi, Seychelles, the Gambia and Zambia.

They can trade under AfCFTA rules

Phase II

Competition Policy
Investment
Intellectual Property

Draft Protocols on Competition, Investment and Intellectual Property were adopted by the AU Assembly in February 2023, with a built in agenda of negotiations on their Annexes and outstanding provisions

Protocol on Investment: Technical negotiations to conclude the Annex on the Rules and Procedures for the Prevention, Management and Resolution of Disputes are ongoing

Phase III

Digital Trade
Women and Youth in Trade

Protocols on Digital Trade, and Women and Youth in Trade, were adopted by the AU Assembly in February 2024

Digital trade

8 Annexes have been agreed and adopted by the AU assembly in February 2025

Women and Youth in Trade

State Parties are to develop a Ministerial Regulation on preferential market access with relevant enabling legal instruments

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To find out more about the African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA) and to download the consolidated text of the Agreement and other key documents, please visit the tralac website at ***bit.ly/AfCFTAresources***

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